MIL-B-48387(AR)
AMENDMENT 1
26 October 1983

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BALL POWDER, IGNITER (BPI)
(FOR USE IN CHARGES, PROPELLING FOR ARTILLERY SYSTEMS)

This Amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-B-48387(PA), dated 1 April 1975, and is approved for use by the US Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 1

Specification Title, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"Ball Powder, Igniter (BPI)
(Spheroidal Propellant Igniter (SPI))"

1.1 Scope, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements and quality assurance provisions for one type of igniter ball powder (spheroidal propellant igniter) for use in ammunition (see 6.1). "

2.1 Add the following:

"DRAWINGS

US Army Armament Research and Development Command

8860 491 - Charge, Propelling, 8 Inch: M1
8861 374 - Charge, Propelling, 8 Inch: M2
8887 277-2 - Charge, Propelling, 155MM: M3A1.
9207 624 - Charge, Propelling, 155MM: M4A2."

FSC 1376

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3.1 Constituent material: For graphite, MIL-G-155, Delete: "Grade III or IV" and substitute "Grade IV".

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3.2.2 Table II, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"Table II

Test	Value
Heat Test 134.5°C	
Discoloration to	
Salmon Pink, Minutes, Min.	45
Explosion, hours, Min.	5
Dust and Foreign matter, %, Max.	0.25
Bulk Density gm/cc	0.525 ± 0.050"

3.3 Delete the table in its entirety and substitute the following:

" Material | Percent

Potassium Nitrate, Max.	0.4
Potassium Sulfate, Max.	0.4
Nitroglycerin, Max.	2.0
Dibutylphthalate, Max.	2.0 "

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3.6 Table III, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"Table III

US Standard Sieve, Size	Percent
25	95 Min. through
30	90 Min. through
60	7 Max. through
70	5 Max. through"

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4.5.1 Table VI, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"Table VI

Properties	Methods
Moisture	T101.6
Nitrocellulose	209.2.1
Dinitrotoluene	208.5.1
Graphite	308.1.4
Diphenylamine	208.5.1
Dibutylphthalate	208.5.1, T226.1, 204.1 or 222.1
Total Volatiles	T103.6
Moisture	T101.6
Heat Test	404.1.2
Dust and Foreign Matter	501.1.3
Bulk Density	502.1.1
Nitroglycerine	208.5.1
Calcium Carbonate	T316.1
Sodium Sulfate	T316.1
Potassium Nitrate	T316.1
Potassium Sulfate	T316.1"

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6.1 Intended use, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"6.1 Intended use. The material covered by this specification is intended for use in charges M1, M2 for 8 Inch and M3A1, M4A2 for 155MM cannons."

6.5 Submission of SMU Form 1047. Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"6.5 Submission of AMCCOM Form 214R. Information contained in propellant description sheet, AMCCOM Form 214R (formerly SMU 1047), need not be resubmitted in the form of a certificate

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provided the provisions regarding certifying of responsible agents is adhered to (see 4.1). Copies of sheets should be forwarded to Commander, AMCCOM, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-R, Dover, NJ 07801 and to Commander, AMCCOM, ATTN: DRSMC-LEM, Rock Island, IL 61299."

6.6 Process control, Change address at end of paragraph to read:

"Commander, AMCCOM, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-R, Dover, NJ 07801 "

6.7 Change address to read:

"Commander, AMCCOM, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-R, Dover, NJ 07801 "

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

(Project 1376-A197)

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